Star Learners Library

Full workflow: catalogue, membership, ordering, delivery, returns and notifications

A. Books and toys (admin)

Admin → Books

- Search by title, shelf code, category or author.
- **Add or edit an item:** title, author, book or puzzle, description, category, reading age and level, minimum and maximum age, pages or pieces, cover type, series name and number, **total copies**, and **which plans can borrow it**.
- **Upload a cover and extra photos**, and drag them into order. Photos are stored on Cloudinary.
- **Delete:** see the warning at the end of this section.

Admin → Inventory

- Shows each item's total copies, how many are out, how many are available, which are out of stock, and the most borrowed.
- **+ / – buttons** change the number of copies. Adding a copy sends a back-in-stock email to anyone waiting for that item.

Admin → Series

- Groups books into a series with a cover, a short description and a reading order. Standalone books can be added to a series, moved up or down, or removed.

Admin → Categories

- Add, rename or delete categories (name, emoji, web address name). They show up as filters in the library.

How availability works

- An item counts as unavailable from the moment it's ordered until it's **marked collected**, including while it's being packed, on its way, with the member, or overdue.
- When every copy is out, members can tap **"Notify me"** and get an email when a copy comes back.
- Each item has a list of allowed plans. For example, Little Reader members can't borrow puzzles, and the app enforces this both in the box and at checkout.

Admin → Overview shows total books, books out, active members, orders to send out, out for delivery, pickups pending, overdue, members who have used up this month's allowance, and recent orders.

> ⚠️ **Deleting an item also wipes its borrowing history, including copies a member has right now.** To retire a copy, reduce the copies count instead. Only delete items that are never coming back.

B. Members joining

1. A parent browses the library, signs up and builds a box or wishlist. Both are saved to their account, so they follow them across devices.

2. **"Buy plan"** opens WhatsApp to the library's number. **There is no online payment**: they pay the library directly.
3. The admin goes to **Admin → Users → member → Assign membership** and picks the plan, length (1, 3, 6 or 12 months) and dates. The admin can also **suspend or reactivate** a member there. The membership ends on its own when the end date passes.

Plan	Allowance per month
Little Reader	5 books, no puzzles
Star Reader	8 items, any mix
Wonder Bundle	6 books + 4 puzzles

Prices and limits can be changed under **Admin → Plans**, and the changes apply to existing members too.

C. Ordering (one bag a month)

4. The member checks out their box. The app checks:
   - they have an active membership,
   - the items fit their allowance and plan,
   - a copy is free,
   - **they haven't already ordered this calendar month.** Ordering reopens on the 1st of next month.
5. **What gets sent:**
   - **Member:** an email and a WhatsApp message saying the order was placed.
   - **Every admin account:** an email with a **packing slip PDF** to print.
6. **The swap:** everything the member still has at home is automatically marked to go back, linked to this new order (see D).

> *An admin can also **place an order for a member** from Admin → Users → member. It works the same way (bag, swap, packing slip) but skips the monthly allowance and the one-order-a-month rule.*

D. Delivery and the swap (Admin → Circulation)

7. **Preparing:** the admin packs the bag using the packing slip.
8. **Assign delivery person** (name, phone, ETA). Their status becomes "Out for delivery".
   - **The same person is automatically assigned to collect the member's old bag.**
   - The member gets an email with who is coming and the ETA. If there's an old bag, it asks them to *keep their current books ready to hand back*.
9. **At the door,** the admin presses one of two buttons:
   - **"Delivered + collected N":** the new bag is delivered and the old bag is closed. The old books go back into stock, the member gets a "returned" email, and anyone waiting on those books gets a back-in-stock email.

    - **"Delivered only":** use this if the old bag wasn't handed over. It stays marked for pickup to deal with later.

10. **The 30-day loan starts on delivery,** not on ordering. The member gets an email with their **return date**.

> *Admins can also set a bag's stage directly if something needs correcting.*

E. Reminders (automatic)

11. A daily job runs at about 8:30 am India time and reminds members **3 days and 1 day before** their return date, by email and WhatsApp. It sends nothing on other days and nothing once a loan is overdue. A member never gets the same reminder twice in one day.
12. Overdue loans show in Circulation and on Overview. Admins can also run the reminders by hand from **Admin → Notifications**.

F. Returns

Usually, returns happen through the swap (D): the next delivery brings the old bag back.

A standalone pickup is only for when there won't be a next delivery:

- **Member side:** "Return bag early" or "Request pickup" only works if **their membership ends before next month's ordering opens**. Otherwise the app says: "*Pickups ride along with your next delivery.*" A bag always goes back whole, never book by book.
- **Admin side:** the admin can arrange a pickup for any bag at any time.

When the member requests one: they get a "return requested" email and every admin gets an in-app notification. The admin then **assigns a pickup person**, and the member gets an email. Finally the admin marks it **collected**: the books go back into stock, the member gets a "returned" email, and back-in-stock emails go out.

G. Other

- **Forgot password:** sends an email with a reset link.
- **Admin → Notifications:** send a promotional email or an in-app message to members.
- **Member account:** their orders (one card per bag, with the return date), wishlist, membership and notifications. Each book page shows how many members have wishlisted it.

H. Emails at a glance

When	Member	Admin
Order placed	Email + WhatsApp	Email with packing slip PDF
Delivery person assigned	Email (asks them to keep old books ready)	—
Delivered	Email with return date	—
3 days and 1 day before due	Email + WhatsApp	—
Return requested	Email	In-app notification
Pickup person assigned	Email	—
Collected or returned	Email	—
Book back in stock	Email (if they asked)	—
Forgot password	Email	—
Promotion	Email	—